

From 0 to \$6K: My Writing Playbook

How I made \$6k in 10 months writing online — with zero strategy and zero expectations.

By Yashwanth Sai

Hey, quick intro

I'm not a professional writer. I'm a researcher, I run an AI lab, and I have a full-time job.

But somewhere along the way, I started writing online — and it changed everything.

\$6k in earnings. 400k+ views. Freelance gigs I never applied for. A full-time high-paying job I got through a connection I made online. And one article that made \$3.5k from 20 minutes of writing.

I'm not telling you this to flex. I'm telling you this because none of it was planned.

This guide is exactly what I wish someone had handed me in 2021 when I first started. No fluff. Just what actually worked.

Why writing still matters (even with AI)

Here's the thing people get wrong. They think AI killed writing as a skill.

It didn't. It killed *bad* writing. Filler content. Generic posts. SEO garbage.

What AI can't replicate is *you*. Your specific experience, your honest take, your voice.

The most basic form of writing — taking your raw thoughts and turning them into something another person can understand — is one of the most powerful things you can train your brain to do.

And here's the part nobody talks about: writing is the foundation of almost every other valuable skill.

- Sales? Writing.
- Marketing? Writing.
- Communication? Writing.
- Building a network? Writing.
- Getting a job? Writing.

It compounds into everything else.

My actual journey (the honest version)

I started writing in 2021. For three years, I was just putting stuff out — AI, tech, random thoughts. No real strategy. Low views. That was fine.

Then in August 2024, something clicked. I stopped writing randomly and started writing **with intent**.

Every post had a purpose. Every article was something I genuinely wanted to say — usually something that would've helped past me.

By December 2024, I got serious. January 2025: 300k views on my Twitter articles alone. July 2025: a friend told me Medium pays writers. Two months later, one article blew up — 120k readers, \$3.5k from a single post.

I never searched 'how to make money writing online.' The money was a side effect of doing the actual thing.

The one shift that changed everything

Writing with intent.

Before this shift, I was writing to write. After it, I was writing to say something specific to someone specific.

Ask yourself before every post:

- Who is this actually for?
- What do I want them to walk away thinking or doing?
- Would this have helped me 6 months ago?

That last question is the most useful filter I've found. If the answer is yes, write it. If not, skip it.

Where to write

- **Medium** — Best for long-form articles. You get paid based on reading time from paid subscribers. Takes time to build but has real upside. Start here if you want money from writing itself.
- **Twitter / X** — Great for short takes, building in public, and reaching people fast. Good for testing ideas before writing full articles.
- **Instagram** — Underrated for writers. Short scripts, carousels, behind-the-scenes. Good for a different audience than Twitter.

My advice: pick one, get consistent, then expand. Don't do all three from day one.

Building in public without cringing

This is the thing that holds most people back. The fear of putting your thoughts out there.

Here's what I've learned: nobody cares as much as you think. And the people who do care — those are your people.

Building in public means: learn something, write about it, share it — even if you don't feel qualified yet. Then do it again. Keep iterating.

Don't shitpost. Don't post for numbers. Create something you'd actually want to read yourself.

I've gotten 10+ job offers, freelance gigs, and collaborations without actively looking for any of them. All from people finding my writing online. The opportunities find you — you just have to be visible.

Getting started: the 3-step loop

This is literally all I do. Still. Today.

1. Read

Good books, good articles, stuff in your field. You can't pour from an empty cup. Even 20 minutes a day shifts how you think.

2. Write

Put your thoughts into words. Doesn't have to be perfect. Write like you're explaining something to a friend. Your natural voice is your biggest advantage — don't sand it off trying to sound professional.

3. Share

Post it. Instagram, Medium, X — doesn't matter. Just put it somewhere public. The act of sharing makes you take it seriously, and it's the only way the right people find you.

Repeat this loop. That's the whole playbook.

The real payoff

The money is real and I won't pretend it isn't nice. But the actual thing writing gave me is harder to measure:

- I think more clearly
- I communicate better
- I've built genuine relationships with people I never would've met
- I have a full-time job I love because someone read my writing

- I wake up feeling like I'm documenting something real

Writing is the one skill that makes every other part of your life better. It's not a content strategy. It's how you develop yourself in public.

Start messy. Start today. You'll figure out the rest as you go.

If this helped, follow me on Instagram for more. I share what I learn as I learn it.